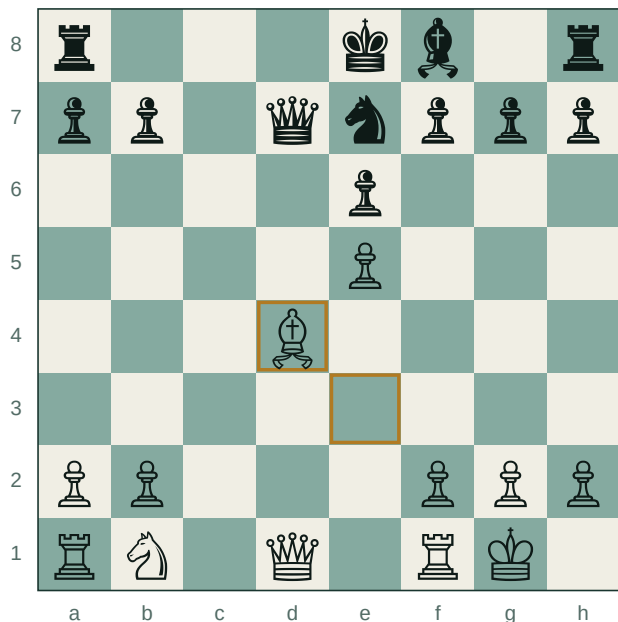


Quiet tactical moves: Black, move 12

Quiet tactical moves

Black to move



Previous move: 12.Bxd4. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

12...Rd8 13. Nc3 Qxd4 14. Qxd4 Rxd4

12...Rd8 The rook moves from a8 to d8. Recorded reply: **13.Nc3**.

13...Qxd4 The queen captures the bishop on d4. From d4 it attacks queen on d1 and knight on c3. Recorded reply: **14.Qxd4**.

14...Rxd4 The rook captures the queen on d4.

At the end, nominal material is White 19 / Black 22 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, Black's balance changes by +3. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does Black's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer:** +3: the balance goes from +0 to +3. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

Because the move is not forcing by check, the opponent has time for counterplay. Test every serious check and direct threat.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

A quiet move can win by threatening something the defender cannot meet, even though it gives no check and makes no capture. It often supplies the missing support in a near-working combination.

HOW TO LOOK

Use failed forcing lines to identify an escape square or defender. Search for a move that removes that resource while keeping the threat.

The defending king is on g1. Geometrically undefended: rook on a1. Check for tactical protection.